County of San Diego, Health and Human Services Agency (HHSA)
Special Notice

Supplemental Security Income (SSI) and State Supplementary Payment (SSP) Cost-of-Living Adjustment (COLA)	**Number**	**Page**
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Effective Date:
01/01/2025

Background:
SSI and SSP recipients received a COLA effective January 1, 2025.

Policy:
New Applicants
The actual amount of SSI/SSP benefits, including the COLA adjustment, must be used for eligibility and budgeting purposes beginning in January 2025. The SSI/SSP amount budgeted for January will be considered reasonably anticipated income for applications received in January 2025.

Ongoing Households (HHs)
SSI/SSP COLA updates are considered verified upon receipt (VUR). The Department of Health Care Services (DHCS) performs a data match against CalSAWS to produce a file with the updated SSI/SSP payment amounts due to the COLA adjustment.

Based on the information received SSI/SSP payment amounts were updated accordingly:

If an SSI/SSP recipient's…	**then the SSI/SSP payment amounts were…**
ELIGIBLE amount is less than or equal to their PAID amount,	adjusted to the ELIGIBLE amount automatically in CalSAWS on January 11, 2025. Changes to the HH's benefit allotment will take effect February 2025.
PAID amount is less than their ELIGIBLE amount or their SSI/SSP benefits could not be matched,	not automatically updated in CalSAWS. SSI/SSP payment amounts must be adjusted at the next Eligibility Status Report (SAR 7) or recertification, whichever comes first.

A PAID amount that is less than the ELIGIBLE amount indicates a possible recoupment. The reason for the recoupment must be explored at SAR 7 or recertification, whichever comes first, and the SSI/SSP income must be included in the budget as follows:

If the recoupment is due to…	**then use the following SSI/SSP amount in the budget…**
an SSI/SSP overpayment,	the PAID amount.
any other reason,	the ELIGIBLE amount.

Ongoing Transitional CalFresh (TCF) Cases
TCF cases containing an SSI/SSP recipient had their SSI/SSP payment amounts automatically adjusted in CalSAWS on January 11, 2025; however, the new payment amounts will not be used in the budget until the TCF period ends.

Procedure:
The following case list reports along with action to take will be shared:
- Programs Discontinued by the SSI COLA Batch Eligibility Determination and Benefit Calculation (EDBC) Process
- SSI COLA Batch EDBC Process Closed a Person
- Unprocessed Cases Where the SSI COLA Batch EDBC Process Skipped a Program
- Monthly SSI-SSP Other Program Assistance (OPA) Record Not Updated

References:
All County Information Notice (ACIN) I-74-22, I-74-22E, I-52-24.

Sunset Date:
12/31/2025

Approval for Release:



Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services